

Name: Bharath Arun Gandhimani

Student ID: 35501308

Applied Session: 7 | Teaching Associates: Michael Niemann & Ayden Zhou

Project Title: From Roads to Classrooms: Educational Infrastructure Investment, Socioeconomic Equity, and Household Travel Behavior in Victoria (2023–2025)

Aims:

This visualisation communicates three connected findings to Victorian policymakers and transport planners:

- Education infrastructure investment broadly tracks where households are located across Victoria's LGAs
- Higher investment tiers correlate with greater car dependency, not active or public transport uptake
- Neighbourhood disadvantage — not investment level alone — is the stronger predictor of how households travel

The goal is to show where government spending and community transport need are aligned, and where they are not.

Motivation:

Victoria spends billions annually on regional infrastructure — but investment alone does not guarantee equity. If funding concentrates in already well-connected areas, or if economically disadvantaged households cannot access viable transport options, the gap between government intention and community outcome widens. This project combines VISTA 2024–25 travel survey data, the 2023–24 State Budget Infrastructure Investment Map, and ABS SEIFA 2021 indexes to assess whether infrastructure decisions are spatially and socially aligned with real household travel demand — and what that means for equity in daily mobility across Victoria.
